

LAST DAY AT WORK CHECKLIST

A final day at a job is more than a formality—it is the closing chapter of a professional experience and an opportunity to leave with clarity, professionalism, and strong relationships intact. A thoughtful approach ensures responsibilities are transitioned smoothly, knowledge is preserved, and connections remain positive. The following checklist outlines key steps to help make a last day organized, respectful, and forward-looking.

1 Before Your Last Day

1.1 Confirm Departure Details

- ☐ Verify your official end date with HR and your manager
- ☐ Review benefits end date (health insurance, retirement, etc.)
- ☐ Clarify final paycheck timing and unused vacation payout
- ☐ Understand non-compete or confidentiality obligations

1.2 Create a Transition Plan

- ☐ List all ongoing projects
- ☐ Identify deadlines and key contacts
- ☐ Share access instructions (without violating security policies)
- ☐ Document status updates for each task
- ☐ Prepare step-by-step guides for recurring responsibilities

2 Wrap Up Your Work

2.1 Complete or Reassign Tasks

- ☐ Finish high-priority assignments
- ☐ Send handover emails summarizing project statuses
- ☐ Delegate remaining tasks clearly
- ☐ Inform stakeholders of new points of contact

2.2 Organize Files and Systems

- ☐ Clean up shared drives
- ☐ Remove personal files from company devices
- ☐ Return physical documents to proper storage
- ☐ Label and organize folders clearly
- ☐ Back up personal contacts (if permitted)

3 Return Company Property

- ☐ Laptop and charger
- ☐ Keys
- ☐ Equipment or uniforms
- ☐ ID badge and access cards
- ☐ Company credit cards
- ☐ Remote work equipment

4 Communicate Professionally

4.1 Inform Colleagues

- ☐ Send a farewell email or message
- ☐ Thank your team and leadership
- ☐ Share personal contact information (if appropriate)
- ☐ Express appreciation without negativity

4.2 Attend Exit Interview (If Scheduled)

- ☐ Provide constructive, professional feedback
- ☐ Be honest but diplomatic
- ☐ Avoid personal criticism
- ☐ Offer suggestions for improvement

5 Protect Your Professional Reputation

- ☐ Avoid speaking negatively about the company
- ☐ Leave on time and respectfully
- ☐ Continue performing at a high standard through the final hour
- ☐ Say goodbye in person when possible